

PMP Key Knowledge Points

English Translation Sample - Points 1-9

Print-Friendly Review Page

PMBOK terminology aligned with professional project management usage

01 Project Definition and Characteristics

A project is a temporary endeavor undertaken to create a unique product, service, or result. Temporary means the work has a defined beginning and end; it does not imply a short duration. Uniqueness means each project produces a distinct output. Progressive elaboration refines plans as information becomes clearer and estimates become more accurate.

02 Portfolio vs. Program

A portfolio is a collection of projects, programs, and related work managed to achieve strategic objectives. Portfolio management emphasizes value maximization, prioritization, resource allocation, and strategic alignment. A program is a group of related projects managed together to obtain benefits that would not be available if managed separately; the key word is interdependency.

03 Project Management vs. Operations Management

Projects and operations both involve people, limited resources, planning, execution, and control in support of organizational objectives. The core distinction is that projects are temporary and unique, ending when objectives are achieved, while operations are ongoing and repetitive, sustaining normal business performance.

04 Life Cycle Selection

Life cycle choice depends mainly on scope clarity and delivery frequency. Predictive approaches fit clear scope and infrequent delivery. Iterative approaches fit high change with low delivery frequency. Incremental approaches deliver usable outputs in batches. Adaptive or agile approaches fit high change and frequent delivery.

05 Work Performance Data

Work performance data consists of raw observations and measurements collected while project work is being performed. Examples include percent complete, quality measurements, activity start and finish dates, change request counts, defect counts, actual cost, and actual duration. These data are usually recorded in the project management information system and project documents.

06 Work Performance Information

Work performance information is performance data analyzed in control processes and compared with the project management plan and project documents. It may describe deliverable status, implementation of change requests, forecasts, or estimates to complete. Data are collected during execution and then converted into information through monitoring and controlling.

07 Work Performance Reports

Work performance reports are physical or electronic project documents that compile work performance information to support decisions, actions, and management attention. They are prepared from work performance information and may include status reports, progress reports, dashboards, and formal management updates.

08 Data, Information, and Reports

Work performance data are first-hand records captured during execution. Work performance information is produced during monitoring and controlling by analyzing variances between actual results and the plan. Work performance reports aggregate this analysis at the project level, often for customers, sponsors, or senior management, to determine whether action is required.

09 Enterprise Environmental Factors vs. Organizational Process Assets

Enterprise environmental factors are conditions outside the direct control of the project team that influence, constrain, or direct the project; they may help or hinder the work and must often be followed. Organizational process assets are accumulated, updateable organizational knowledge and resources that can support future projects and may be tailored by the project manager.